

Kyra Hoffman

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EDUCATION

Vassar College | Poughkeepsie, NY
Bachelor of Arts in Environmental Studies
GPA 3.75 / 4.00; Major GPA 3.80 / 4.00

May 2024

Thesis: A Dam Solution: Understanding the potential of beavers in stream restoration in Casperkill watershed
Dr. Deon Knights

HONORS & AWARDS

The Collins Student Research Fund, Envir. Research Institute, Vassar College

2023

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Jill Troy Werner Sustainability Education Fellow, Vassar College
Office of Sustainability

Jul. 2024 – Present

- Supervising multiple teams of students through data collection and analysis projects
- Coordinating lab exercises as the teaching assistant for environmental science courses
- Played a key role in pushing Vassar College's decarbonization plan forward and in developing their five-year climate action plan
- Updated and maintained Vassar's sustainability data platforms including developing a project database and a sustainability map

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Asst., Earth Science Department, Vassar College
Dr. Deon Knights

Jun. – Aug. 2024

- Compiled and interpreted large amounts of data
- Created a model of nutrient removal using GIS and Microsoft Excel in an urban stream
- Drafted and working to publish a research paper

Research Asst., Envir. Research Institute, Vassar College
Dr. Deon Knights

Jun. – Aug. 2023

- Conducted multi-hour benthic chamber and solute tracing experiments in the field, collecting water samples
- Ran water samples through an ion chromatograph and correcting the resulting curves
- Completed an eight-page literature review of beaver wetland hydrology
- Working compiling conclusions in a poster presentation

Research Asst., Undergraduate Research Summer Institute, Vassar College
Dr. April Beisaw

May – Jul. 2022

- Trained on and proficient in the use of GIS, ArcGIS, and GPS in Field Work
- Collected and compiled large amounts of data to support research
- Developed final report communicating research and key stories

Research Asst., Earth Science Department, Vassar College

Jan. – May 2022

Dr. Kirsten Menking

- Collected water samples at multiple points of the year
- Completed spectrophotometry on a series of lake water samples, examining nutrient levels.
- Finished a report on findings of nutrient pollution and made recommendations about further steps for remediation

RESEARCH SKILLS

Field Work: Water sampling, Benthic chamber experiments, Dilution gauging and solute tracing, GPS marking and tracing, Archaeological unit digging/shovel test pits, Surveying, Well slug and bail testing, Aquifer characterization

Wet Laboratory: Light/Polarizing microscopy, Spectrophotometry, Ion Chromatography, X-Ray Diffraction

PRESENTATIONS

American Geophysical Union Conference, New Orleans, LA

Dec. 2025

Poster: "The Effects of Beaver Ponds on Nitrate Uptake in an Urban Stream"

Envir. Research and Praxis Symposium, Vassar College

Feb. 2024

Poster: "The effects of seasonality and nutrient loading on nutrient uptake in an urban beaver wetland"

American Geophysical Union Conference, San Francisco, CA

Dec. 2023

Poster: "The effects of seasonality and nutrient loading on nutrient uptake in an urban beaver wetland"

New York State Archaeological Conference, Orange, NY

Apr. 2023

Poster: "Champagne and Shadows: Mapping the Costs of City Water"

Poster: "Research Using the New York Poorhouse Spatial Database"

MEMBERSHIPS

American Geophysical Union

Jun. 2023 – Present

Geological Society of America

Jun. 2023 – May 2025

Sigma Xi

May 2024 – May 2025

SKILLS

Certifications:

R Certified

Platforms:

Google Workspace (Advanced) , Office 365 (Advanced), ArcGIS (Pro, Online, Storymaps, Fieldmaps), QGIS, Adobe Creative Cloud (Photoshop, Illustrator), Canva, Procreate